

Carrier Johnson — re-anchor with the new leadership

A San Diego institution (independent, employee-owned, founded 1977, ~70 staff; offices SD / LA / Seattle / Atlanta). KOR is a real structural partner — anchored by the award-winning **West / 1011 Union** tower — but the firm just replaced its entire C-suite, so the job is to re-connect the relationship led by that one project.

Know before you walk in: new leadership as of March 2026 — **David Huchteman = CEO, Marin Gertler = Chief Design Officer, Claudia Escala = President**; founder Gordon Carrier is now Executive Chairman. Co-founder **Michael Johnson passed away in Feb 2024** — reference with care.

KOR'S CALLING CARD

West / 1011 Union St (Courthouse South Block) — a 38-storey downtown mixed-use tower for Holland Partner Group, **2025 Gold Nugget winner**, with post-tensioned slabs, a hidden outrigger system and below-water-table excavation. KOR was structural engineer of record. Technically serious, publicly documented — this is what opens the conversation. (KOR also engineered CJ's **Obelisk on 5th / 1555 5th Ave.**)

HOW THE SEAT GETS CHOSEN

Carrier Johnson has **no locked-in structural firm** — they choose alongside the developer, project by project. That cuts both ways: **no competitor to displace**, but CJ alone can't hand KOR a seat — the developer (Holland, Cisterra, Elda, etc.) co-decides. The goal is simply to be on their shortlist for the next downtown San Diego residential tower.

WHO TO TALK TO (emails Apollo-verified · main line 619-239-2353)

Kristen Chidester	Director, Marketing + Proposals · kec@carrierjohnson.com · 619.687.2416 — the door; start here , she routes the intro to principals
David Huchteman	CEO (new 2026) · deh@carrierjohnson.com — the decision-maker; came from AC Martin, mixed-use background (KOR's lane)
Alex Gutiérrez	Design Director · agg@carrierjohnson.com — presented publicly on the Courthouse towers KOR engineered ; warmest specific contact
Frank Landry	Technical Director · fal@carrierjohnson.com — the engineering-coordination contact; ex-City Building Appeals commissioner
Marin Gertler	Chief Design Officer (new) · mlg@carrierjohnson.com — came from the developer side (IQHQ); speaks ROI
Claudia Escala	President · cce@carrierjohnson.com — continuity through the transition; built the Seattle office

THE PLAY

- **Open through Chidester** to reach Huchteman and Gutiérrez — Gutiérrez already knows the KOR towers first-hand.
- **Lead with 1011 Union:** "We were your structural on the Gold Nugget tower — we'd like to re-connect with the new leadership and be on your list for the next downtown project."
- **Ask, don't assume:** which of their active San Diego multifamily jobs are still selecting structural (their North Park apartment project cleared approval in March 2026 — a natural one to raise).
- **One internal check first:** confirm what "5702 Linda Vista Rd" is on our own record before citing it — it didn't surface publicly, and a wrong detail on our own past project is an easy stumble.